3-7 Patient fire v.1

Evidence of fire (smoke, heat, odour, flash, flame) on patient or drapes, or in patient's airway

START

❶ Call for help and inform theatre team:

- Activate fire alarm
- Dial hospital fire emergency number and report location and nature of fire
- Bring CO_2 fire extinguisher into theatre

EQUIPMENT LOCATIONS

Fire alarm:

Fire extinguisher:

If **AIRWAY** fire:

❷ Extinguish fire:

- Stop laser or diathermy
- Discontinue ventilation AND fresh gas flow
- Remove tracheal tube if on fire
- Remove flammable material from airway
- Flood airway with 0.9% saline

❸ After fire extinguished:

- Re-establish ventilation
- Minimise O_2, avoid N_2O
- Check airway for damage and debris
- Consider bronchoscopy
- Re-intubate

If **NON-AIRWAY** fire:

❷ Extinguish fire:

- Stop laser or diathermy
- Remove all drapes and burning material
- Flood fire with 0.9% saline or saline soaked gauze
- Use CO_2 extinguisher

❸ After fire extinguished:

- Re-establish ventilation
- Minimise O_2, avoid N_2O
- Assess damage
- Consider inhalational injury if not intubated
- Consider intubation depending on degree of injury

❹ Assess patient and devise ongoing management plan

- Confirm no secondary fire, assess smoke risk to patient, consider intensive care.

❺ Keep involved materials or devices for inspection and report to the MHRA.

❻ If secondary non-patient fire occurs, or concerned about smoke/fire risk to staff, follow local fire procedures.

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